INDIA TODAY
www.indiatoday.in

CHAIRMAN AND EDITOR-IN-CHIEF: Aroon Purie
VICE CHAIRPERSON AND EXECUTIVE EDITOR-IN-CHIEF: Kalli Purie
GROUP CHIEF EXECUTIVE OFFICER: Dinesh Bhatia

GROUP EDITORIAL DIRECTOR: Raj Chengappa

CHIEF EXECUTIVE OFFICER: Manoj Sharma

GROUP CREATIVE EDITOR: Nilanjan Das; **GROUP PHOTO EDITOR:** Bandeep Singh
EDITOR (FEATURES): Kai Jabir Friese
MANAGING EDITORS: Sunil Menon, S. Sahaya Ranjit; MUMBAI: M.G. Arun
EXECUTIVE EDITORS: Manisha Saroop, Kaushik Deka
SENIOR DEPUTY EDITORS: Sangram K. Parhi, Sasi Nair;
HYDERABAD: Amarnath K. Menon
DEPUTY EDITORS: Anilesh S. Mahajan, Pradip R. Sagar;
JAIPUR: Rohit Parihar; MUMBAI: Suhani Singh
SENIOR EDITORS: Sonali Acharjee, Ashish Mukherjee, Saikat Niyogi;
PATNA: Amitabh Srivastava
SENIOR ASSOCIATE EDITORS: Sonal Khetarpal; MUMBAI: Dhaval. S . Kulkarni;
AHMEDABAD: Jumana Shah; BHOPAL: Rahul Noronha
ASSOCIATE EDITOR: Avishek G. Dastidar, Vipul Grover; BENGALURU: Ajay Sukumaran
SPECIAL CORRESPONDENT: KOLKATA: Arkamoy Datta Majumdar
PHOTO DEPARTMENT: Chandra Deep Kumar, Rajwant Singh Rawat (Deputy Chief Photographers), Arun Kumar (Principal Photographer);
MUMBAI: Mandar Suresh Deodhar (Chief Photographer)
PHOTO RESEARCHERS: Prabhakar Tiwari (Deputy Visual Research Editor),
Saloni Vaid (Chief Photo Researcher),
Jodha Singh Adhikari (Principal Photo Researcher)
CHIEF OF GRAPHICS: Tanmoy Chakraborty
ART DEPARTMENT: Sanjay Piplani (Creative Editor),
Angshuman De (Senior Art Director), Rajesh Kumar Angira, Bhoomesh Dutt Sharma (Associate Art Directors), Santosh Kumar Sharma (Assistant Art Director), Praveen Kumar Gummadi (Chief Designer),
Siddhant Jumde (Chief Illustrator)
PRODUCTION DEPARTMENT: Harish Agarwal (Chief of Production),
Naveen Gupta (Chief Coordinator)

CHIEF OPERATING OFFICER
Suparna Kumar

IMPACT TEAM
Senior General Managers: Mayur Rastogi (North), Jitendra Lad (West),
Syed Naveed (Chennai)
GROUP CHIEF MARKETING OFFICER: Vivek Malhotra
SALES AND OPERATIONS
Deepak Bhatt, National Head (Distribution)
Vipin Bagga, General Manager (Operations)
Rajeev Gandhi, General Manager (North)
Yogesh Godhanlal Gautam, Regional Sales Manager (West)

INDIA TODAY GROUP

Volume 49-Number 45; For the week
October 29-November 4, 2024, published on every Friday

• Editorial/Corporate Office Living Media India Ltd., India Today Group Mediaplex, FC-8, Sector-16A, Film City, Noida - 201301; Phone: 0120-4807100 • Subscriptions: For assistance contact, Customer Care, India Today Group, C-9, Sector-10, Noida (UP) – 201301. email: wecare@intoday.com; Phone / Whatsapp: +91 8597 778 778 (Monday to Friday, 10 am – 6pm). • Sales: Direct all trade enquiries to General Manager (Sales), Living Media India Limited, C-9, Sector-10, Noida-201301 (UP). • Regd. Office: F-26, First Floor, Connaught Place, New Delhi-110001. • Impact Offices: 1201, 12th Floor, Tower 2 A, One Indiabulls Centre, (Jupiter Mills), S.B. Marg, Lower Parel (West), Mumbai-400013; Phone: 022 69193355; Fax: 66063226 • E-1, Ground Floor, Videocon Towers, Jhandewalan Extn, New Delhi. • Door No: 610, 610A, 612, 5th Floor, Block A, Imperial Chaitanya Building, Anna Salai, Teynampet, Chennai, Tamilnadu-600018. • 201-204 Richmond Towers, 2nd Floor, 12, Richmond Road, Bangalore-560025; Phones: 22212448, 22213037, 22218343; Fax: 22218335; • 52, Jawaharlal Nehru Road, 4th Floor, Kolkata-700071; Phones: 22825398; Fax: 22827254; • 6-3-885/7/B, Somajiguda, Hyderabad-500082; Phone: 23401657, 23400479, 23410100, 23402481, 23410982, 23411498; Fax: 23403484 • 39/1045, Karakkatt Road, Kochi 682016; Phones: 2377057, 2377058 ; Fax: 2377059 • 2/C, "Suryarath Bldg", 2nd Floor, Behind White House, Panchwati, Office C.G. Road, Ahmedabad-380006; Phone: 26560393, 26560929; Fax: 26565293 • Copyright Living Media India Ltd. All rights reserved throughout the world. Reproduction in any manner is prohibited.
Printed and published by Manoj Sharma on behalf of Living Media India Limited. Printed at Thomson Press India Limited, 18-35 Milestone, Delhi Mathura Road, Faridabad-121007, (Haryana) and at Rajhans Enterprises, 134, Industrial Town, 4th Main Road, Rajajinagar, Bengaluru-560044, (Karnataka).

Published at F-26, First Floor, Connaught Place, New Delhi-110001.

Editor: Raj Chengappa.

• INDIA TODAY does not take the responsibility for returning unsolicited publication material.

All disputes are subject to the exclusive jurisdiction of competent courts and forums in Delhi/New Delhi only

SYNDICATIONS TODAY INDIA DELIVERED
For **reprint rights** and **syndication** enquiries, contact syndications@intoday.com or call +91-120-4078000
www.syndicationstoday.in



Photo Montage by BANDEEP SINGH

ASSEMBLY POLLS 2024

THE MAHA BATTLE FOR SURVIVAL

The do-or-die duel between two major alliances over Maharashtra will decide the fate of its regional parties and have national repercussions

JHARKHAND: WOOING THE TRIBAL HEART >> PG 28

INSIDE

UPFRONT
INDIA-CHINA: PATROL FOR PEACE PG 6

WAYANAD BYPOLLS: PRIYANKA'S CHARM OFFENSIVE PG 12

LEISURE
BOOKS: WARP & WEFT OF HISTORY PG 51

Q&A WITH DIA MIRZA PG 62

UTTAR PRADESH
32 CAUGHT IN THE POLITICAL CROSSFIRE
Flagship projects from the Samajwadi Party era remain unfinished in Yogi raj

THE PANNUN PLOT
36 OPERATION MESS-UP
A US court's indictment of an ex-RAW agent is a narrative of an amateurishly run op

SOLAR POWER
40 REVOLUTION ON THE ROOFTOP
The adoption of Muft Bijli scheme is helping households save money and India meet targets

DATING APPS
44 DATING UPDATED
As users complain of dating app fatigue, new features are trying to lure them back

Note to the reader
From time to time, you will see pages titled 'An Impact Feature' or 'Focus' in INDIA TODAY. These are no different from advertisements, and the magazine's editorial staff is not involved in their creation in any way.

Cover by **NILANJAN DAS;** *photographs by* **BANDEEP SINGH; MANDAR DEODHAR**

INDIA TODAY GROUP

Readers are recommended to make appropriate enquiries before sending money, incurring expenses or entering into commitments in relation to any advertisement appearing in this publication. The India Today Group does not vouch for any claims made by the advertisers of products and services. The printer, publisher, editor-in-chief and the editor of the India Today Group publications shall not be held liable for any consequences in the event of such claims not being honoured by the advertisers.

FOR SUBSCRIPTION ASSISTANCE, CONTACT: Customer Care, India Today Group, C-9, Sector-10, Noida (UP) - 201301. email: wecare@intoday.com | Phone / Whatsapp: +91 8597 778 778 (Monday to Friday, 10 am - 6pm)

SCAN HERE TO SUBSCRIBE

E-MAIL to: **letters.editor@intoday.com** or log on to **www.indiatoday.in**